

# CRAM SHEET

## *Bladder & Kidney Channels – Week 5*

67 + 27 = 94 points · Foot-Taiyang & Foot-Shaoyin

**Quiz Ready · Posterior Circuit Complete**

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### **BLADDER**

67 pts · Water/Yang  
3–5 PM · 5 branches

### **KIDNEY**

27 pts · Water/Yin  
5–7 PM · 3 branches

### **CIRCUIT**

Posterior/Inner done:  
HT+SI+BL+KI

+ trap notes, confusable pairs, Back-Shu series, and full special-points map inside

## BL PATHWAY — 5 branches

1. Inner canthus -> vertex
2. vertex -> temple
3. vertex -> bladder
4. lumbar region -> popliteal fossa
5. posterior neck -> little toe

1st: BL1 Jingming · Last: BL67 Zhiyin

## BL SPECIAL POINTS

Jing-Well: BL67 Zhiyin  
 Ying-Spring: BL66 Zutonggu  
 Shu-Stream: BL65 Shugu  
 Jing-River: BL60 Kunlun  
 He-Sea: BL40 Weizhong  
 Yuan-Source: BL64 Jinggu  
 Luo-Connecting: BL58 Feiyang  
 Xi-Cleft: BL63 Jinmen  
 Front-Mu (of Bladder): CV3 Zhongji  
 Back-Shu (of Bladder): BL28 Pangguangshu  
 Command Point (back): BL40 Weizhong

## BL BACK-SHU SERIES (BL13–BL28) — organ transport points

BL13 Lung · BL14 Pericardium · BL15 Heart · BL18 Liver · BL19 Gallbladder · BL20 Spleen · BL21 Stomach · BL22 San Jiao · BL23 Kidney · BL25 Large Intestine · BL27 Small Intestine · BL28 Bladder

## QUICK FACTS

BL: Water/Yang · peak 3 PM – 5 PM · pertains Bladder, connects Kidney · paired with KI · Front-Mu CV3 (Zhongji) · Back-Shu BL28 (Pangguangshu)

KI: Water/Yin · peak 5 PM – 7 PM · pertains Kidney, connects Bladder · paired with BL · Front-Mu GB25 (Jingmen) · Back-Shu BL23 (Shenshu)

## BL FUNCTION LOGIC

### Running-course function:

Two branches cross the head/brain -> headache. Two long parallel lines run the entire back -> low back pain, calf pain, stiff leg, sciatica-type pain along the pathway.

### Internal-organ function:

Pertains to the Bladder -> urination disorders. Dr. Zhang notes acupuncture is particularly effective for urinary retention — cites a clinical case where a single point resolved the presentation.

### Back-Shu bridge function:

BL13–BL28 are the Back-Shu (transport) points for all twelve zang-fu organs, so BL is also the channel you reach for to treat any other organ system via its associated Back-Shu point (e.g., BL13 Lung, BL15 Heart, BL18 Liver, BL20 Spleen, BL21 Stomach, BL23 Kidney, BL25 Large Intestine, BL27 Small Intestine, BL28 Bladder).

## KI PATHWAY — 3 branches

1. Small toe -> kidney -> bladder (main pathway)
2. kidney (re-emerging) -> root of the tongue
3. lung -> Pericardium Meridian

1st: KI1 Yongquan · Last: KI27 Shufu

## KI SPECIAL POINTS

Jing-Well: KI1 Yongquan  
 Ying-Spring: KI2 Rangu  
 Shu-Stream: KI3 Taixi  
 Jing-River: KI7 Fuliu  
 He-Sea: KI10 Yingu  
 Yuan-Source: KI3 Taixi  
 Luo-Connecting: KI4 Dazhong  
 Xi-Cleft: KI5 Shuiquan  
 Front-Mu (of Kidney): GB25 Jingmen  
 Back-Shu (of Kidney): BL23 Shenshu  
 Confluent (opens Yinqiao Mai): KI6 Zhaohai

## KI FUNCTION LOGIC

### Running-course function:

Pathway curves behind the medial malleolus/heel -> heel pain (Dr. Zhang's explicit clinical cue). Terminates at the tongue root -> dry mouth, sore throat, tongue-root diagnostic signs.

### Internal-organ function:

Kidney stores Essence (Jing) and grasps Qi (governs respiration at its root) — treats asthma-type presentations because the channel connects internally with the Lung. Also governs water metabolism, bone, marrow, and hearing.

## BL TRAP NOTES

- TRAP: BL does NOT connect to the Lung. Do not confuse with LU or the Metal-element pathway — BL's internal connection is Kidney only (confirmed midterm-era trap note).
- The two parallel lines on the back (1.5 cun and 3 cun lateral to the spine) run SIMULTANEOUSLY, not as a sequential loop. Dr. Zhang confirmed in Q&A: a student asked whether the back line travels down, back up, and down again, or runs both lines at the same time — answer: "at the same time." Do not draw it as one line doubling back.
- BL has 14 cross-points total, shared with two other channels: the Governor Vessel (GV) and the Gallbladder (GB) channel, concentrated around the head. You are not expected to know each of the 14 individually — only that BL shares crossing points with GV and GB.
- BL7 (Tongtian) is NOT the vertex-joining point — that is GV20 (Baihui), which BL merely joins at the vertex.

## COMMONLY CONFUSED POINTS

### BL60 vs BL62/BL63:

BL60 Kunlun (Jing-River, mid-Achilles) sits above BL62 Shenmai (Confluent, directly below malleolus) and BL63 Jinmen (Xi-Cleft, anterior-inferior to BL62). All three cluster around the lateral ankle — map them from the malleolus outward.

### KI3 vs KI7:

KI3 Taixi = Shu-Stream + Yuan-Source, in the malleolus/Achilles depression. KI7 Fuli = Jing-River, 2 cun proximal to KI3, anterior to the Achilles tendon.

### KI6 vs KI7:

KI6 Zhaohai (Confluent, Yinqiao Mai, below the malleolus) is functionally distinct from KI7 Fuli (Jing-River, tonifies Yang) despite being nearby.

### BL40 vs BL54 vs BL57:

All are leg/thigh points on the same posterior line: BL40 Weizhong (popliteal crease, He-Sea/Command) -> BL54 Zhibian (upper thigh/sacrum) -> BL57 Chengshan (calf belly, 8 cun below BL40). Sequence matters for the running-course quiz format.

## BL CLINICAL PEARLS

- BL40 (Weizhong): He-Sea, Command point for the back; clears summer-heat; low back pain.
- Back-Shu points (BL13-BL28): organ transport points — treat the corresponding zang-fu organ directly from the back.
- BL60 (Kunlun): called the "aspirin of acupuncture" — headache, pain anywhere along the pathway, difficult labor.
- BL67 (Zhiyin): corrects fetal malposition with moxibustion; used for labor induction.
- BL62 (Shenmai) and BL63 (Jinmen) sit close together on the lateral foot below the malleolus — BL62 is the Confluent point (opens Yang Qiao Mai); BL63 is the Xi-Cleft.

## KI TRAP NOTES

- CLINICAL TEACHING POINT (Dr. Zhang, verbatim emphasis): heel pain — think Kidney first. The channel curves directly behind the medial malleolus and through the heel, and this is called out explicitly as a common clinical presentation.
- KI intersects the Spleen channel at SP6 (Sanyinjiao) on the medial leg — a shared crossing point, not a KI-numbered point.
- Do not confuse KI3 (Taixi, Yuan-source AND Shu-stream — a dual role) with KI7 (Fuli, Jing-river). Both sit near the medial malleolus/Achilles tendon: KI3 is in the depression between the malleolus tip and the Achilles tendon; KI7 is 2 cun above KI3, anterior to the Achilles tendon.
- KI6 (Zhaohai) is the Confluent point opening the Yinqiao Mai (Yin Heel Vessel) — do not mix up with KI7, which is a Jing-river (five-transport) point with a different clinical profile.

## KI CLINICAL PEARLS

- KI1 (Yongquan): Jing-Well; resuscitation, calms the spirit; used in hypertension.
- KI3 (Taixi): Yuan-source; the key tonic point for Kidney Yin AND Yang.
- KI6 (Zhaohai): Confluent (Yinqiao Mai); insomnia, sore throat, irregular menstruation.
- KI7 (Fuli): tonifies Kidney Yang; edema; night sweats (often paired with HT6).
- KI27 (Shufu): final point of the channel, inferior border of the clavicle — links functionally into the chest before the Pericardium channel begins.

## BL – all 67

|             |            |             |              |             |            |             |          |             |           |
|-------------|------------|-------------|--------------|-------------|------------|-------------|----------|-------------|-----------|
| <b>BL1</b>  | Jingming   | <b>BL15</b> | Xinshu       | <b>BL29</b> | Zhonglvshu | <b>BL43</b> | Gaohuang | <b>BL57</b> | Chengshan |
| <b>BL2</b>  | Zanzhu     | <b>BL16</b> | Dushu        | <b>BL30</b> | Baihuanshu | <b>BL44</b> | Shentang | <b>BL58</b> | Feiyang   |
| <b>BL3</b>  | Meichong   | <b>BL17</b> | Geshu        | <b>BL31</b> | Shangliao  | <b>BL45</b> | Yixi     | <b>BL59</b> | Fuyang    |
| <b>BL4</b>  | Quchai     | <b>BL18</b> | Ganshu       | <b>BL32</b> | Ciliao     | <b>BL46</b> | Geguan   | <b>BL60</b> | Kunlun    |
| <b>BL5</b>  | Wuchu      | <b>BL19</b> | Danshu       | <b>BL33</b> | Zhongliao  | <b>BL47</b> | Hunmen   | <b>BL61</b> | Pucan     |
| <b>BL6</b>  | Chengguang | <b>BL20</b> | Pishu        | <b>BL34</b> | Xialiao    | <b>BL48</b> | Yanggang | <b>BL62</b> | Shenmai   |
| <b>BL7</b>  | Tongtian   | <b>BL21</b> | Weishu       | <b>BL35</b> | Huiyang    | <b>BL49</b> | Yishe    | <b>BL63</b> | Jinmen    |
| <b>BL8</b>  | Luoque     | <b>BL22</b> | Sanjiaoshu   | <b>BL36</b> | Chengfu    | <b>BL50</b> | Weicang  | <b>BL64</b> | Jinggu    |
| <b>BL9</b>  | Yuzhen     | <b>BL23</b> | Shenshu      | <b>BL37</b> | Yinmen     | <b>BL51</b> | Huangmen | <b>BL65</b> | Shugu     |
| <b>BL10</b> | Tianzhu    | <b>BL24</b> | Qihai        | <b>BL38</b> | Fuxi       | <b>BL52</b> | Zhishi   | <b>BL66</b> | Zutonggu  |
| <b>BL11</b> | Dazhu      | <b>BL25</b> | Dachangshu   | <b>BL39</b> | Weiyang    | <b>BL53</b> | Baohuang | <b>BL67</b> | Zhiyin    |
| <b>BL12</b> | Fengmen    | <b>BL26</b> | Guanyuanshu  | <b>BL40</b> | Weizhong   | <b>BL54</b> | Zhibian  |             |           |
| <b>BL13</b> | Feishu     | <b>BL27</b> | Xiaochangshu | <b>BL41</b> | Fufen      | <b>BL55</b> | Heyang   |             |           |
| <b>BL14</b> | Jueyinshu  | <b>BL28</b> | Pangguangshu | <b>BL42</b> | Pohu       | <b>BL56</b> | Chengjin |             |           |

## KI – all 27

|            |          |             |         |             |          |             |          |             |          |
|------------|----------|-------------|---------|-------------|----------|-------------|----------|-------------|----------|
| <b>KI1</b> | Yongquan | <b>KI7</b>  | Fulu    | <b>KI13</b> | Qixue    | <b>KI19</b> | Yindu    | <b>KI25</b> | Shencang |
| <b>KI2</b> | Rangu    | <b>KI8</b>  | Jiaoxin | <b>KI14</b> | Siman    | <b>KI20</b> | Futonggu | <b>KI26</b> | Yuzhong  |
| <b>KI3</b> | Taixi    | <b>KI9</b>  | Zhubin  | <b>KI15</b> | Zhongzhu | <b>KI21</b> | Youmen   | <b>KI27</b> | Shufu    |
| <b>KI4</b> | Dazhong  | <b>KI10</b> | Yingu   | <b>KI16</b> | Huangshu | <b>KI22</b> | Bulang   |             |          |
| <b>KI5</b> | Shuiquan | <b>KI11</b> | Henggu  | <b>KI17</b> | Shangqu  | <b>KI23</b> | Shenfeng |             |          |
| <b>KI6</b> | Zhaohai  | <b>KI12</b> | Dahe    | <b>KI18</b> | Shiguan  | <b>KI24</b> | Lingxu   |             |          |

## COURSE MILESTONE

Week 5 completes the Posterior Circuit (also called Inner Circuit on earlier slide versions): HT and SI (Week 4) plus BL and KI (this week) form the full four-channel posterior/inner circuit. Dr. Zhang's own framing at the end of Lecture 5: "until now, we have learned the posterior circuit, and four meridians consist of the posterior circuit."